LEE FAMILY PRACTICE

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Michael S. Kaplan, M.D., Diplomate, A.B.F.P, F.A.A.F.P.
Family Practice and Geriatrics
Melanie R. Levitan, M.D., Diplomate, A.B.F.P.
Family Practice

Kathy Korte, F.N.P.
Family Nurse Practitioner
Ann Hummel, F.N.P.
Family Nurse Practitioner

Ms. Tamara Thorpe-Odom

Walter B. Howard Elementary School

1478 Route 20

New Lebanon, NY 12124

25 August, 2010

Dear Ms. Thorpe-Odom:

This letter is regarding Victoria Lehtonen. Victoria is unable to attend school at present do the effects of her Lyme Disease, Babesiosis, and Bartonella. Additionally, she is undergoing extensive treatment for these conditions, which is leaving her fatigued, with frequent headaches, nauseous irritable, disordered sleep and febrile.

She will need the assistance of the school district with her education in the form of a home tutor for this school year. This home tutor will be needed indefinitely at this point. She is medically unable to be tutored more than 2 hours daily total time and even that needs to be in one hour aliquots with a 15-30 minute break between sessions. Because of her fatigue, she needs to sleep in the morning, so a consistent start time of 11 AM is necessary.

She is being evaluated by multiple national experts in this emerging field and I am optimistic that she will make consistent and steady progress. However, you must understand that there is still much that is not understood about these conditions and their natural progression. Her condition, therefore will vacillate unpredictably both in the short and over the longer term. I will keep you informed of changes in her status.

I am certain that you are as concerned as I am for Victoria's health, welfare and education. I am sure that together, we can assist Victoria and her family through this difficult period. Thank-you you for your understanding and cooperation in this matter.

Melanie Levitan, MD

Kenneth B. Liegner, M.D., P.C.
Internal & Critical Care Medicine
Lyme Borreliosis & Related Disorders
8 Barnard Road
Armonk, New York 10504
(914) 273-2121
FAX: 914 273-4801
November 6, 2009

Walter B. Howard Elementary School
1478 Route 20
New Lebanon, NY 12124
ATT: Tamara Thorpe-Odom

RE: Victoria Lehtonen

Victoria is unable to attend school at the present time due to the effects of her illness (Lyme disease and babesiosis) as well as the impact of treatment upon her.

Please assist Victoria with home tutoring at this time and at least through December 4th when I will be reassessing her.

She will be following up with me on a regular basis and I will up-date you on her status and whether or not continued home tutoring is necessary.

Thank you in advance for your cooperation.

If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Very truly yours,

Kenneth B. Liegner, M.D.

Member, Treatment Panel, N.I.H. State-of-the-Art Conference on Lyme Disease, March 1991, Bethesda,MD.

Co-Chair, Treatment Poster Discussion Section, Fifth International Conference on Lyme Borreliosis, May/June 1992, Arlington, VA.

Participant, N.I.A.I.D. Consultations on Chronic Lyme Disease, February & October 1994, Bethesda, MD.

Associate Editor, Journal of Spirochetal and Tick-borne Diseases.

Member, Program Committee, 7th International Conference On Lyme Borreliosis, San Francisco, CA., Spring 1996.

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Lyme Borreliosis & Related Disorders
8 Barnard Road
Armonk, New York 10504
(914) 273-2121
FAX: 914 273-4801
March 19, 2010

Walter B. Howard Elementary School
1478 Route 20
New Lebanon, NY 12124
ATT: Tamara Thorpe-Odom

RE: Victoria Lehtonen

Victoria is unable to attend school at the present time due to the effects of her illness (Lyme disease and babesiosis) as well as the impact of treatment upon her.

Please assist Victoria with home tutoring at this time and at least through April 16``, 2010 when I will be reassessing her.

She will be following up with me on a regular basis and I will up-date you on her status and whether or not continued home tutoring is necessary.

Victoria is making slow but definite positive progress; however her status any given day or part of the day is quite variable and unpredictable. For this reason I would strongly favor continued tutoring in the home setting.

Thank you in advance for your cooperation.

If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Very truly yours,

Kenneth B. Liegner, M.D.

Member, Treatment Panel, N.I.H. State-of-the-Art Conference on Lyme Disease, March 1991, Bethesda,MD.

Co-Chair, Treatment Poster Discussion Section, Fifth International Conference on Lyme Borreliosis, May/June 1992, Arlington, VA.

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Lyme Borreliosis & Related Disorders
8 Barnard Road
Armonk, New York 10504
(914) 273-2121
FAX: 914 273-4801
September 30, 2009

Berkshire Country Day School
P.O. Box 867
Lenox, MA 01240
ATT: Health Personnel & Administration

RE: Victoria Lehtonen

Victoria Lehtonen has been under my care since 7/22/09. She has been ill with complex multi-system symptoms since Spring of 2009. She had had a respiratory illness Fall 2008 from which she seemed to recover. A copy of the transcript of my initial visit and all labs developed here accompany.

Evaluation here developed serologic evidence of exposure to *Mycoplasma pneumoniae*, Rocky Mountain Spotted Fever, Lyme disease and babesiosis.

She has been treated with doxycycline but does remain significantly symptomatic and is compromised. After a diagnosis of babesiosis was made, treatment was changed to azithromycin combined with atovaquone. Amoxicillin is being added. She remains under care and additional testing is being obtained today.

It would be desirable if accommodations could be extended to Victoria as she recovers from her illness. Ideally she should have flexibility with the extent of her participation in sports. Additional time for completing assignments and examinations would be helpful as would a reduced academic load if that is feasible. Since she has been unable to attend classes on a regular basis, home tutoring would seem necessary and desirable.

Very truly yours,

Kenneth B. Liegner, M.D.

Member, Treatment Panel, N.I.H. State-of-the-Art Conference on Lyme Disease, March 1991, Bethesda,MD.